Sunday 7th July, 8.30pm

HybriD (8'30")

Steve Adam

Clarinet: Darren Howard

Violin: Helen Eadie

Bass Clarinet: Paul Todd

Bass Guitar: Justin Ashworth

Saxophone: Catherine Hocking

Flute: Melanie Chilianis

Percussion and Electronics: Matthew Bush

HybriD is a collaborative work between contemporary music group *re-sound* and the composer, for multiple acoustic instruments, live computer processing and synthesis. The title of the piece reflects the relationship of its elements on various levels. The resources offered by a relatively large ensemble coupled with the mix of real-time computer generated sound offer the potential to achieve a sound world reflecting elements of both the real and virtual. In addition, the merging of performance 'data' derived from each of the performers enables a mix of influences that result in the creation of sounds that are effectively 'hybrids'. As the piece and the software are in ongoing development, this particular performance is presented as a snapshot capturing an early phase of its evolution. This project has been assisted by the Commonwealth Government through the Australia Council, its arts funding and advisory body.

Steve (aka Stelios) Adam has composed sound and music works for a variety of media and performed with bands, instrumentalists, choirs and interactive music systems of his own design. His electro-acoustic works have been broadcast nationally and performed in Europe, the US and Japan. He has taught music composition and technology at various institutions in Australia and in 1995 he established the new programs and technical facilities in composition and music technology at Monash University, where he has been a PhD candidate in the specialty of music composition since early in 2002. In addition, he currently teaches computer-based composition at Scotch College in Melbourne and works on music and sound projects of a widely varying nature on a freelance basis.

222|4|581 (6'30")

FNDA

*FNDA are known in the electronic music scene as **masters of sound**, specialising in creating audio material for electronic musicians. Their sounds have been used by a range of artists, producers, and MI manufacturers, for example in **"Battery"** the audio programme by Native Instruments.*

Amnesia (7'00")

Julian Knowles

The video materials for *Amnesia* were all captured in a one hour period from 6.30-7.30pm whilst on the foreshores of Sydney Harbour. This idea of limiting myself to materials captured in a specific timeframe is an idea I have worked with in the piece 'one_day' (2000). The main visual element is the surface of the water and refracted light through the dusk period into night. The audio materials are a combination of materials recorded in oil and water tanks on location at Casula Powerhouse (an old coal fired power station), 'ghetto blaster feedback' in the aforementioned acoustic spaces and digitally reprocessed guitar. Materials collected from an urbanised traditional site, Bennelong Point, are framed to avoid the urban elements (probing for history), which becomes increasingly difficult as night falls and the urban space becomes part of the water surface via reflected light. This sets up a potent irony, as one becomes seduced by the modulating light underneath the foreboding 'scape' of the Harbour Bridge. The soundtrack of the power station underpins this journey. This piece was originally presented as part of the *Placescapes* exhibition at Goya Galleries, Melbourne.

Julian Knowles is a composer/performer working with computers, sound synthesis, field recording and digital audio processing. His work spans studio and live performance, composition, and sound design for film, exploring the inherent

(im)possibilities of various audio manoeuvres and uncovers the musicality of unlikely sound sources. He synthesises elements from an eclectic range of sonic practices such as acousmatic music, film sound, location recording, pop music production techniques, surround sound and audio dsp. As a solo performer, Julian has toured the UK, USA, Latin America and Korea to critical acclaim and is also a member of the group Social Interiors (Extreme Records). He is currently a Senior Lecturer and Electronic Arts/Music Technology Co-ordinator at the University of Western Sydney.

Canopies: chimerical acoustic environments (12'15")

Lawrence Harvey

Canopies was originally commissioned by the Southgate Arts and Leisure Precinct for their Soundscape System located in central Melbourne. This system comprises 160 loud speakers distributed along approximately 200 metres of the Yarra River promenade and controlled via an audio server.

The image of a woven sonic lattice and the speaker configuration of the Soundscape playback system suggest a covering suspended or held overhead; a canopy. The environments suspended within a canopy are chimerical; fictitious, fanciful, fantastic, fictional, illusory. Listening to the soundscape of an environment we may hear and imagine a weave of connections and transformations; the real and imagined fuse into the other.

The predominantly low frequency nature of the city soundscape, had to be taken into account while designing the sounds for Canopies. This led to the use of sounds in mid to high frequency bands that are richly textured and varied. The sound sources for the work included transformed recordings made from a set of wood-chimes, a collection of shells, a set of beads and small brass bells and cymbals. These sound sources were selected for their ability to create dense sonic complexes. Other material was created from various synthesis techniques and transformed vocal improvisations.

Canopies installation version is designed for a transitional space; a stairwell, an arcade, or the promenade of a river. The concert realisation provides a sense of transition through several differentiated environments and combines material from the original installation, and transformed versions of those sounds.

Production for the installation version took place between November 1999 and January 2000. The original set of environments ? approx 10 ? formed the basis of a cyclic soundscape presented every evening (6pm-11pm) between January 18 and April 21, 2000. This concert version of the work was produced in January 2001, and was premiered at CREATE, University of California, Santa Barbara 17 May, 2001.

Lawrence Harvey - Associate Reseacher in Acoustic Ecology and Soundscape Studies, School of Architecture and Design, RMIT, and sound designer for Metraform. Recent projects include VR sound design for "Symbiosis" shown at both the Melbourne Film (2001) and Next Wave Festivals (2002). With Metraform, he is currently completing a large commission to create "Ecstasis: human presence in digital environments", funded by the Digital Media Fund of Film Victoria (formerly Cinemedia).

Resonances (10'00")

Jim Barbour

Resonances is in homage to Alvin Lucier, and takes his seminal work *'I am sitting in a Room'* into a 21st century surround sound environment. Using a similar technique, *Resonances* explores the acoustic resonances in the three dimensional space of a performance venue, where the directionality of several voices are gradually overwhelmed by reflections and reverberation. Where once there were individual words with inherent meaning, in their place will be bell-like tones and melodies sharpened by occasional sibilance. By the end, all that will remain is a sound field without specific identity.

Jim has extensive experience working with sound in Australia and overseas, with more than twenty years as a music producer and recording engineer and many years as a production manager in Commercial radio. Following on from Electrical Engineering studies at Adelaide University, Jim worked overseas and in Australia in the music industry producing audio for vinyl, CD, film, video and television releases. Credits include Recording Engineer for Men at Work's 'Business As Usual', Sound Supervisor for the Australian Opera at the Adelaide Festival Theatre, film music awards for Aboriginal Film 'Wrong Side of the Road' and Advertising awards for radio production. Jim also worked at the Elder Conservatorium of Music and the Queensland Conservatorium of Music in their Electronic Music Studios, and tutored students in recording techniques and composition using electro-acoustic instruments and music synthesisers. He performed in concerts of experimental music and assisted in the creation of sound sculpture installations.

Over the last fourteen years, Jim has designed and delivered training programs at Swinburne University of Technology in Radio and Multimedia Authoring. He completed a Master of Arts in Communications at Swinburne in 2000, with a thesis titled 'The Digitization of Acoustic Space: The Impact of new Digital Audio Technologies on Aural Perception'.

Jim also holds a Graduate Diploma of Education in Information and Communications Technology from Melbourne University, specialising in Multimedia authoring and production.

INTERMISSION

Maison (14'00")

'Maison' is the second movement of a suite called 'C'est la Vie' which explores various aspects of life. 'Maison' takes home life, or family life, as its primary source material. Toys that take over their owner's household is an age old theme that story-tellers have used for centuries. What happens when ordinary household sounds take on a life of their own?

'Maison' uses Ross Bencina's *Audiomulch* program extensively (see www.audiomulch.com <http://www.audiomulch.com/>). Original source sounds were made by Caitlin and James Hirst.

David Hirst is an electroacoustic music composer and academic. He studied computer music at La Trobe University and graduated with a Master of Arts by research. David resides in Australia where he has worked as a lecturer in electronic music and composition at the University of Tasmania, as a Senior Lecturer in Contemporary Music Technology at La Trobe University, and as a courseware designer at the University of Melbourne.

David,s electroacoustic music has been performed nationally and internationally. His compositions include works for live electronics, film, theatre, installations, and recordings. He has also served the Australasian Computer Music Association as both president and secretary, and is currently on the board of the Australian Music Centre.

Crashing II (7'00")

Donna Hewitt - music

Nell Andrew dance

Crashing was originally from a larger dance work called *Beyond the Depths* - a collaboration between choreographer, Nell Andrew and composer, Donna Hewitt, which was performed at the Edge Theatre in Sydney in February 2002. Our mutual interest in the ocean and its plethora of environments and moods inspired the work. The pieces explore the diverse life forms and environments that exist within the ocean, including the various layers or 'zones' ie the 'Midnight', 'Moonlight' and the 'Twilight' Zone. *Crashing* sought to explore some of the more extreme of ocean environments and was one of the more successful works. *Crashing II* is a development of the original piece, which extends and develops the original musical ideas to form a stand alone work, and has been re-arranged for multi-channel sound to enhance the immersive experience for the listener. The source sounds are drawn from a library of captured and found sound, including air and hydrophone recordings of marine environments and found objects which are subjected to digital reprocessing. These sound sources are drawn upon for live processing and mixing via AudioMulch, allowing for close communication between dancer and composer during the performance.

Donna Hewitt is a composer/performer working with voice, environmental and computer processed sound. Much of her work involves re-processing audio via various digital processes to produce complex textures. As a PhD scholarship student in the Music Area at UWS, she is working with multichannel audio and has completed a number of studio pieces in the Dolby 5.1 surround format. Recently she has been exploring real time digital performance systems and custom interfaces in object/patcher environments. Recent performances/screenings include 'Liquid Extrusion' ArtHouse 2002, 'Beyond the Depths of Silence' The Edge Theatre 2002 'Peep Show' Most Significant Bytes 2001 Concert Series, Ohio, USA; Impermanent Audio 2001, Waveform 2001, Electronic Antiphony, Melbourne 2001, Sonic Residues 02 Australian Centre for Contemporary Art, Melbourne 2000; Llewers Gallery, Fuse Exhibition 1999, The Mill on the Floss (Sydney Theatre Company/Babylon Productions) The Wharf Theatre 1999, 'Drowning' Watt concert 1998. Her work is released on a number of compilation CDs.

His Masters Voice (9'03")

Jeff Pressing

This work is for two performers: live voice, and vocal samples triggered and controlled by two MIDI keyboards. These samples are generated by an Akai sampler and signal-processed in real-time by a Max program written by Jim Sosnin and the composer. One keyboard selects the pitch of the samples to be played, and the other selects the processing type and parameters in the chosen processes. The vocal sounds focus on extended vocal techniques, ethnic borrowings, harmonic reinforcement, and phonetics of an imaginary composed language. The intention is to create a dialogue between the live performer and samples, with the computer acting as a third agent.

In formal terms, the piece is in three, contiguous parts: the first is linear and abject; the second busy, variegated and whimsical; and the third is a codetta based on part one. This recording is of the live performance by the composer at the 1993 International Computer Music Conference in Tokyo, Japan.

Jeff Pressing was an experienced composer and performer of music with extensive background in the physical sciences and psychology of music. He has published widely in a number of fields. In 1990 he was a Composer-in-Residence with the Australian Broadcasting Corporation, completing Zalankara, a multicultural electroacoustic symphony. Pressing is the author of the book Synthesiser Performance and Real-Time Techniques.

Tempered Dekanies (2001, 10')

Greg Schiemer

Combination product sets - just intonation scales created by contemporary tuning theorist Erv Wilson – are formed when combinations of a set of harmonics are multiplied together. The dekany is a 10-note CPS scale generated by multiplying all combinations of pairs of harmonics from a set of five harmonics. *Tempered Dekanies* uses two dekanies; the first generated from harmonics 1, 3, 7, 9 and 11, the second from harmonics 1, 3, 5, 7 and 9.

The title takes its name from the pitch deviation that is a central feature of the piece. The deviation is an extension of Risset's chorusing instrument in which each pitch is heard together with a collection of microtonally detuned pitches, tuned above and below a central pitch. Unlike Risset's chorus where the bend above and below the central pitch is equal, the effect achieved here is produced using by a pair of just and non-equal microtonal ratios, 100/99 above and 99/98 below. Detuning takes place gradually over the duration of each note to produce beats that gradually accelerate and decelerate throughout the piece. The work is realised using Csound.

Greg Schiemer (b.1949) is a composer and instrument-builder who has been active in the Sydney experimental music scene since 1970. His dance-theatre work Brolga (1973) was one of the earliest developments in Australian computer music. In collaboration with experimental choreographer Phillippa Cullen (1972-75) he created interactive electronic music using theremins as a control interface for dance movement. His Spectral Dance (1992), Token Objects (1993) and Shantivanam (1996), performed at festivals in Australasia, Greece, Japan & Hong Kong, involve the use his purpose-built interactive electronic instrument designs such as the Tupperware Gamelan and the MIDI Tool Box. He has been active in the development of more recent new music technology as recipient of an Australia Council Composer's Fellowship at the CSIRO Division of Radiophysics (1994) and as chief investigator in a Collaborative Australian Research Council Grant with Lake Technology as industry partner (1997). His just intonation studies Transposed Hexanies, were presented at ACMA, QUT (2000) and at MicroFest, Los Angeles (2001). He lectures in electronic music at Sydney Conservatorium of Music where he is currently the acting chair of composition.